



The war dragged on for nine years, but the Trojans wouldn't give in, and, try as they might, the Greeks couldn't break through the city's defenses. The army's frustrated commanders began to fight among themselves. In particular, Achilles and Agamemnon were constantly arguing. Both were convinced they were the other's superior. Their constant squabbles eventually came to a head when Agamemnon stole one of Achilles' favorite slaves, the beautiful Briseis. Achilles was furious. "I refuse to fight alongside that arrogant Agamemnon until he returns Briseis to me."

*Achilles waited in his tent for Briseis to be returned. Agamemnon stoutly refused.*

The fighting continued, but without Achilles, the Greeks were weak. It began to look like they would be defeated and have to return home. Although his fellow soldiers pleaded with him to return to the battle, Achilles would not budge. Even the man he loved the most, Patroclus, could not convince him.

Patroclus decided to take matters into his own hands. When all the warriors had gone to sleep, he sneaked into Achilles' tent and stole his armor. The next day, he put it on himself and marched into battle disguised as Achilles! The Greeks cheered, and the Trojans trembled in fear.

